

Regular Meeting

Monday/September 17, 2018

School Committee Meeting, Council Chambers

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke in the Council Chamber at 7:20 PM. Those present were: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard Vincent and Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell.

Meeting called to order at 7:23 PM Attendance

Roll Call Vote - 7-0

Approval of minutes from last meeting – Please make (2) changes, adds page numbers and change figure for compressors...should read \$15,000 not \$50,000.

Approved as amended, all those in favor, none opposed, motion passes.

Approval of bills and transfer of funds be approved –Roll call vote, motion passes, none opposed

Vote - 7-0.

Motion for approval of payroll – Roll Call Vote

Vote 7-0 motion passes

Report of the Secretary – Ms. Kreatz - Wanted to thank the Yearbook Advisor, Mr. Ambrose, & Yearbook staff to going the extra mile with the 2018 Yearbook Supplement. Also, the slide arrived at Columbus School. DPW is trying to work to make it fit. Medford/Malden Elks reached out to her, regarding an essay scholarship program, which will provide a monetary gift for 5th, 6th, 7th and 8th graders. Would this have to go onto agenda to be approved by the School Committee?

Mayor Burke – We will check that and get back to you. Motion to accept the Secretary's report.

Motion passes, none opposed

Mayor Burke – Welcome Chioma Opara – the new MHS Representative to the Medford School Committee

Report of Committees – Committee of the Whole just met and voted to name the band room at Medford High School, after former School Committee Member Lena DiGiantommaso. Ms. Van der Kloot made the motion to accept, and Ms. DiBenedetto 2nd the motion.

Mr. Ruggiero asked that a plaque be placed. Ms. Van der Kloot asked that a plaque dedication/reception take place

Ms. DiBenedetto – yielded floor to City Councillor Michael Marks, who spoke about Ms. DiGiantommaso and this long overdue honor. Thanked the School Committee for their due diligence on this matter.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot,

Roll Call Vote – 7-0, motion passes, none opposed

Motion to take agenda items out of order – motion passes. Move approval of liquor licenses for (2) upcoming events at Medford High School and the Medford Vocational Technical High School.

Event #1 – Retirement Party for City Clerk Ed Finn – at Bistro 489 -

Event #2 – Medford Kiwanis Hosts Taste of Italy – In Rotunda of Medford High School

Ms. DiBenedetto – As long as we are careful, we should approve this. Security should be addressed. But we look at it as more business for Bistro, I move approval

Ms. Van der Kloot – I would just like to know the process, since we haven't approved liquor licenses recently.

Mayor Burke – Both groups still have to apply for a (1) liquor license from Liquor Commission, but they do need our approval to host events.

Ms. Van der Kloot, 2nd the motion.

Roll Call Vote – 7-0, motion passes for these two events.

Ms. DiBenedetto - While we are under suspension, I'd like to address old business, namely the PTO registration form process.

Jennie Graham, Brooks PTO – form was drafted for PTO transparency. It's a google form. It needs to be transferred to the Medford Public Schools. Form takes 5 minutes to complete. Most PTO's are 501c3 charities. Ms. DiBenedetto – So any group who uses our buildings, has to go to training and complete form? Ms. Graham – I believe so. Ms. Van der Kloot - PTO's need to be contacted and forms need to be sent out. Not sure deadline will be met. Ms.. Graham – Once

this is completed, each of you would have access to see what PTO's are raising & spending their money on.

Discussion ensued. Should service clubs such as Kiwanis be required to complete this online form? Should policy be updated? Mayor Burke– Kiwanis raises money in community and donates funds for schools as they see fit. Since this is not on our calendar, we didn't mean to delve into this, so this will have to be a discussion for another day.

Ms. Van der Kloot – While we are under suspension, I do not see anything on calendar regarding updating the compressors. Many are in need of repair/replacement, at a cost of \$15,000 per compressor. Clearly this is an item for capital planning, and I just wanted to reference it.

Motion to refer to regular order of business – motion passes

Report on Roberts Playground Project – Assistant Superintendent of Finance Kirsteen Patterson presented the report. Contractor is from New Jersey. Could take 4-5 weeks to get tiles. They are unable to expedite due to nature of the tiles needed. Tiles require hand cutting, so more labor intensive as well. Mr. Johnson picked the color blue for the tiles.

Motion to accept the report and place on file, motion passes

Report on Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent's Entry Plan – In your packets, you will find my entry plan. I am planning to look at the data to see where we have excelled, and where we are struggling. I am also reviewing the data on EL, students with disabilities, our attendance, suspensions, our budget and our emergency plans. The final phase will be using the data to establish the priorities for the Medford Public Schools. All of this is part of New Superintendent Induction Program. I plan to invite my mentor, Dr. Karla Baehr, to a School Committee meeting. Mayor Burke – Any questions? Ms. Mustone – I would ask that you please add renovation and upkeep of maintenance from John McLaughlin. Dr. Edouard-Vincent – I will do so, thank you. Ms. Van der Kloot. - Where are you with the central office and your administrative assistant position? Dr. Edouard-Vincent – I am looking through resumes now.

Motion to accept report and place on file, motion passes

Report on Agero & Medford Kiwanis Donations to the Medford Public Schools – Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell – Ms. Caldwell – we are so appreciative of Agero & the Kiwanis donations. Mayor Burke - Please send thank you to these organizations on our behalf.

Motion to accept this report and place on file – motion passes

Report on Sixth Grade Numbers – Director of Curriculum & Instruction Ms. Bernadette Ricciardelli. This report was prepared in response the question raised at the last meeting. None

of the students who did not get their middle school request, left this district. All 17 students in question are still enrolled in the Medford Public Schools.

Motion to accept this report and place on file – motion passes

Report on the Opening of Bistro 489 – Principal/Director Mr. Chad Fallon – The Bistro opens Wednesday/October 3rd, for the community, faculty and staff. The hours of operation will be 8:00 AM – 12:30 PM. Wednesday, Bistro will just serve breakfast items, Thursday & Friday, hours will remain same, but lunch will also be served in addition to breakfast. Mayor Burke – How many students are in the culinary program? Mr. Fallon – 10-12. Mayor Burke – With (1) Instructor? Mr. Fallon – (2) Instructors. Ms. DiBenedetto – What is the approximate cost for breakfast/lunch? Mr. Fallon – They are still working on that, but prices and menu will be available online. Eventually, the students in the access program will be operating the teacher's coffee shop. I am currently working on that project with Ms. Jan Hollenbeck and will let you know when that is up and running.

Motion to accept this report and place on file – motion passes

Ms. DiBenedetto – I have other vocational questions. Mayor Burke – The report is on file. If you want something else on the agenda, please request it for the next meeting.

Report on the Lesley University Partnership – Athletic Director, Mr. Robert Maloney - Floor in gym is almost completed. They are (3) weeks behind scheduled due to extreme weather conditions. We appreciate this partnership as it is giving the Medford High School Gym quite an upgrade. Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent – In addition, Lesley University will be providing us with many professional development opportunities and assistance in improving our math numbers. Ms. DiBenedetto – I'm happy to see the PD opportunities. When I met with SEPAC, they were hoping for a disability component? Dr. Edouard-Vincent – I will address that with them. Mr. Ruseau - I don't see literacy as a focus here. You have to read in order to understand the math. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I beg to differ. There a lot of literacy along with the math, but strong math practices is what our district needs. Our focus will be to improve math instruction. All other content areas will benefit as well. I don't want it to be, we are only looking at math. We are stronger in literacy. Math is our weaker side, to we need to focus on building our math muscles more. Mr. Ruseau -95% reading proficiency is what I would like. 54% of our kids aren't proficient by end of 3rd grade. I don't want them to run before they walk. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We need to look at them developmentally. 3rd grade is first time of first assessment. I still think our kids need time. Look at them over time ... all the way thru high school. I am also thinking about our different populations ...EL for example. It takes 5-7 years to acquire the language, then the students are able to excel/do well. Our gap is getting wider in math . A different level of teaching needed. And we are tackling literacy, with math word problems for example. Mr. Ruseau - Is it possible to get more literacy information, instead of just 1 time per year? Dr.

Edouard-Vincent – yes. Ms. Caldwell - We do assess our students – Journeys, Words their way, etc., but we can certainly get you some information. Ms. DiBenedetto – Can this item be addressed in the curriculum subcommittee, once we receive MCAS report?

Motion to accept this report and place on file, motion passes.

On the motion to refer this report to the curriculum subcommittee, the motion passes.

Negotiations & Legal Matters – Mayor Burke - Roll Call Vote to Ratify MOA Paraprofessional Collective Bargaining Agreement. –

Roll Call Vote – 7-0 contract is ratified

Mayor Burke - Announcement – City of Medford is collecting donations for those affected by gas explosions, as is CCSR. There is a detailed list of what's being accepted on the websites. Citizens can drop at any fire department or at the MHS Main Office. Some of our city/school employees have been affected, so please keep them in mind

Ms. Mustone – What is the status of the safety report?

Mayor Burke - We received a draft copy only today. We will distribute it when it is ready, possibly at the next meeting.

Mayor Burke– On the motion to adjourn, the motion passes. Meeting adjourned at 8:42 PM